

Video Pitch:

Script provided separately for a single-take recording.

A. Problem & Evidence

The target user is a college student with an off-campus lease who will be away for an internship, study abroad, or part of the summer and needs a temporary tenant. They often repeat a listing across social groups and housing boards, while seekers must piece together dates, cost, roommates, and whether the sublet is allowed. UC Davis lists multiple Facebook housing groups, and Illinois says summer is especially difficult for finding a subtenant [1, 2]. Yale advises checking lease rules and getting written landlord permission, while an Illinois campus police report illustrates the risk of fake sublease posts [3, 4].

B. Originality & Differentiation

The insight is that a sublease needs a precise date match and an approval process, while a social post usually ends at the introduction. Alternatives include Facebook and WhatsApp groups, campus housing boards, free university sublet listings such as UCF's, and general sites such as Sublet.com [5, 6]. Sublease Master will serve students across colleges through campus-based feeds with comparable dates, total monthly cost, room details, and self-reported approval status. It will guide both students from first inquiry to written landlord approval before they finalize a deal.

C. MVP & Product Decisions

Core capabilities

- School-email sign-in, \$25 listing checkout, and a form for dates, rent, utilities, room type, roommates, photos, and approval status.
- Campus-based search by overlapping dates and budget; show when each listing was last confirmed.
- In-app inquiries so listers can respond and mark a room matched or unavailable.

- A plain-language checklist that asks both sides to confirm lease rules and written landlord approval before marking a match complete.
- Automatic expiration of stale listings and a way to flag suspicious posts for manual review.

Explicitly out of scope

- Rent payments, deposits, escrow, legal-document generation, or background checks.
- Native iOS or Android apps, automated landlord integrations, and paid nationwide marketing; the MVP is a responsive website.

Measurable MVP goals

- At least 8 of 10 student listers can publish a complete listing in four minutes or less without help.
- At least 8 of 10 seekers can find a listing matching their dates and budget and send an inquiry within two minutes in a seeded 20-listing test.
- In a six-week pilot spanning at least three colleges, publish ten paid listings and reach five matches for which both students confirm written landlord approval.

D. Build Plan, Tradeoffs & Risks

I will build a responsive web app with Next.js and Supabase for school-email sign-in, \$25 listing checkout, campus-based listings, date filters, and inquiries. I will recruit listers through student housing channels at several colleges before inviting seekers, because search needs local inventory. The tradeoff is manual review of flagged posts instead of automated fraud detection, which slows growth but makes early reports easier to assess. The biggest product risk is that an upfront fee suppresses listings; I will track how many eligible listers pay and how often searches return results. A school email proves affiliation, not authority to sublet, so approval status will be labeled self-reported and both students must confirm written landlord consent.

E. 5 ICP Questions

1. WHO:

- Three attributes: college student; holds a private off-campus lease; expects to be away for at least one month while the lease continues.
- Real person fitting profile: to be identified in pilot interviews; no student interview is claimed yet.

2. AGAINST WHAT:

- Current alternatives: campus Facebook or WhatsApp groups, university housing boards, and general sublet sites.
- Why we could win: one current, date-filtered listing and a visible approval checklist reduce repeated questions and unclear handoffs.

3. THE FIRST TEN:

- Invite ten students actively seeking subtenants across several colleges through campus housing organizations and group moderators; ask them to create real listings.

4. PRICE:

- \$25 once per published listing, paid by the outgoing student; searching is free. This is half one competitor's \$50 listing price [7], but willingness to pay is unproven. Later, assume the incoming subtenant pays \$5 per monthly in-app rent payment for convenience and a payment record.

5. SIGNAL:

- Show the \$25 price to 30 eligible listers across at least three colleges; revise it if fewer than ten pay to post. After rent payments are built, test 20 monthly payments and check whether the \$5 fee exceeds processing and support costs [8].

Research sources (accessed September 2026)

[1] [UC Davis, Off-Campus Housing Toolkit](#)

[2] [Illinois, Application & Lease](#)

[3] [Yale College, Off-Campus Living: Subletting](#)

[4] [Illinois Police, Fake apartment sublease](#)

[5] [UCF, Off-Campus Housing Search](#)

[6] [Sublet.com, College Apartment Rentals](#)

[7] [Student Spots, Pricing](#)

[8] [Stripe, Payment Pricing](#)